EXHIBITION PRESS PACK & CURATORIAL BRIEF

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

SHE IS RISING FROM THE NORTH

A Documentary Photography Project, Photo-Book & Education Initiative across Northern Kenya • By Hildah Kathure in Partnership with MOV Foundation

479+	~100	25+ Yrs	90+
Girls Sponsored Through High School	Scholars to University & Colleges	MOV Foundation in Northern Kenya	Authentic Documentary Photographs

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & CURATORIAL NARRATIVE

'She Is Rising from the North' is a landmark documentary exhibition, photographic monograph, and ongoing educational advocacy project chronicling fifteen years of transformative female leadership in Northern Kenya (Isiolo, Samburu, Marsabit, and Garissa counties). Created by acclaimed Kenyan documentary filmmaker and photographer **Hildah Kathure** in partnership with **MOV Foundation (Stichting MOV, The Netherlands)**, the initiative reframes the public perception of Northern Kenya from a narrative of passive vulnerability to one of extraordinary resilience, intellect, and economic agency.

For pastoralist girls, secondary school is rarely a given. Severe distances, costly boarding fees, recurring climate droughts, and deep-seated pressures toward early marriage create profound barriers after primary school. Yet, through long-term sponsorship, 479+ young women have broken through these structural obstacles. Kathure's camera provides an intimate, dignifying witness to their trajectory—from the pastoralist rangelands to university lecture halls, surgical wards, and corporate boardrooms.

THE THREE-ACT STRUCTURE OF THE EXHIBITION & BOOK

ACT I: ON THE GRAZING FIELDS	ACT II: AT SCHOOL	ACT III: ON THE JOB
The pastoralist foundation. Life in Isiolo and Samburu; water journeys, livestock herding, and dreams quietly carried under the desert sun.	The arrival at boarding secondary school. Discovering science, debates, and personal voice. Dreams transform into uniforms, certificates, and ambition.	The graduates in society. Doctors, teachers, veterinarians, hospital CEOs, and entrepreneurs proving education is an engine of generational prosperity.

"Northern Kenya is often described as marginalized. But these girls are not a margin. They are the centre of a future we all share. Inequality is not fate. Education can turn a life around."

— HILDAH KATHURE, Photographer & MOV Liaison Officer

WOMEN WHO ROSE • EVIDENCE OF GENERATIONAL IMPACT

PROFILES IN COURAGE & TRANSFORMATIVE LEADERSHIP

Dr. Zeinab Gura
CEO, Kenyatta University TRRH (Nairobi)
From pastoralist roots in Northern Kenya to leading one of East Africa's premier national referral hospitals. *"Education gave me more than a profession; it gave me the confidence to lead and prove dreams from the North are valid."*

Batula Fayo
Teacher, Kisima Primary School
Educated through MOV Foundation sponsorship, Batula returned directly to her home community to teach the next generation of girls. *"Standing in front of the chalkboard, I show every girl that her mind belongs at the front of the room."*

Kamila Abkanu
Veterinary Doctor & Ag. Director
Acting Director of Livestock for Isiolo County. Protecting pastoralist herds—the vital backbone of community economy. *"Treating animals protects families' dignity, livelihood, and resilience against drought."*

THE ECONOMIC CASE: EDUCATION AS SYSTEMIC COMBAT AGAINST POVERTY

Data compiled within the photo-book highlights that secondary education for a girl in Northern Kenya delivers an estimated **20–25% increase in lifetime earnings** and fundamentally breaks the multi-generational cycle of early child marriage. The initiative advocates for three concrete policy and institutional priorities:

- **Targeted Secondary Boarding Subsidies:** Eliminating the fatal transition gap between Grade 8 and Form 1 where most girls drop out due to boarding fee shortfalls.
- **Fairer Higher Education Financing:** Reforming student loan criteria to prevent pastoralist university qualifiers from forfeiting admissions due to lack of upfront tuition.
- **100% Proceeds Model:** All sales of books and photo prints go directly and transparently into secondary school tuition fees for deserving girls from Isiolo and surrounding counties.

EXHIBITION SPECIFICATIONS & HOW TO ENGAGE

DOCUMENTARY PHOTO-BOOK
Hardcover collector's edition containing 90+ authentic documentary photographs, essays, and economic analysis.
Price: KSh 2,500 (100% goes to school fees)

CURATED MUSEUM PRINTS
Fine-art exhibition prints on archival photographic paper.
A2 Print: KSh 3,000 • **A1 Print:** KSh 5,000
Direct KCB Paybill: **522533** | Acc: **8144533**

EXHIBITION TOUR DATES
Nairobi: Baraza Media Lab
Isiolo: Catholic Mission Hall
Gafarsa: Community Hall
Merti: March 2027 Upcoming

MEDIA, CURATORIAL & DONOR INQUIRIES

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MOV FOUNDATION PARTNERSHIP

MOV Foundation (Stichting MOV)
Active in Northern Kenya education & SME development for 25+ years
Web: www.stichtingmov.nl • **Project Portal:** sherisingnorth.com
High School Sponsorship: KCB Paybill 522533 / Till 8144533